Form No. 723

Lesotho Meteorological Services
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Period: 11th to 20th November 2025 **Season: 2025/2026**

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Ten-Day Agrometeorological Bulletin

…dedicated to the agricultural community

… aimed at harmonizing agricultural activities with weather and climate

Highlights

- **Warm Temperatures**
- **Favourable Cumulative Moisture**

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Rainfall and temperature review (01-10 November 2025)

Rainfall

Fig. 1 shows the observed anomaly which is how much was received differed from what is expected for this time of the year. The north west and south west have started November well, while the south east and parts of the central areas saw deficit in rainfall. Rainfall accumulation since the start of the season August the 1st of 2025 (Fig.2) to date, illustrates the total rainfall recorded across Lesotho. This period has been characterized by significantly higher rainfall in Leribe and Mokhotlong, while the south and central areas received comparatively lower totals. Dekad 31 (Fig.3) shows rainfall significantly below average, consistent with the performance (below normal) observed in areas in the south east Fig 1.

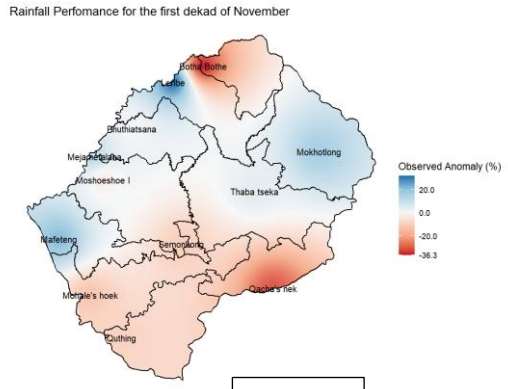

Fig. 1

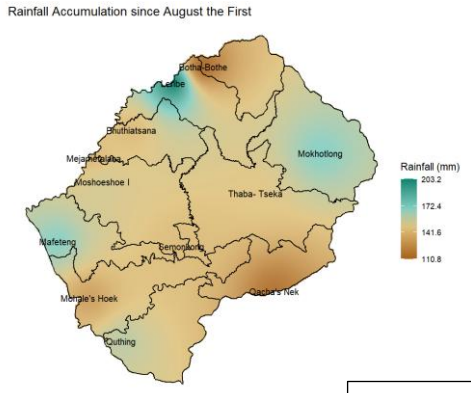

Fig. 2

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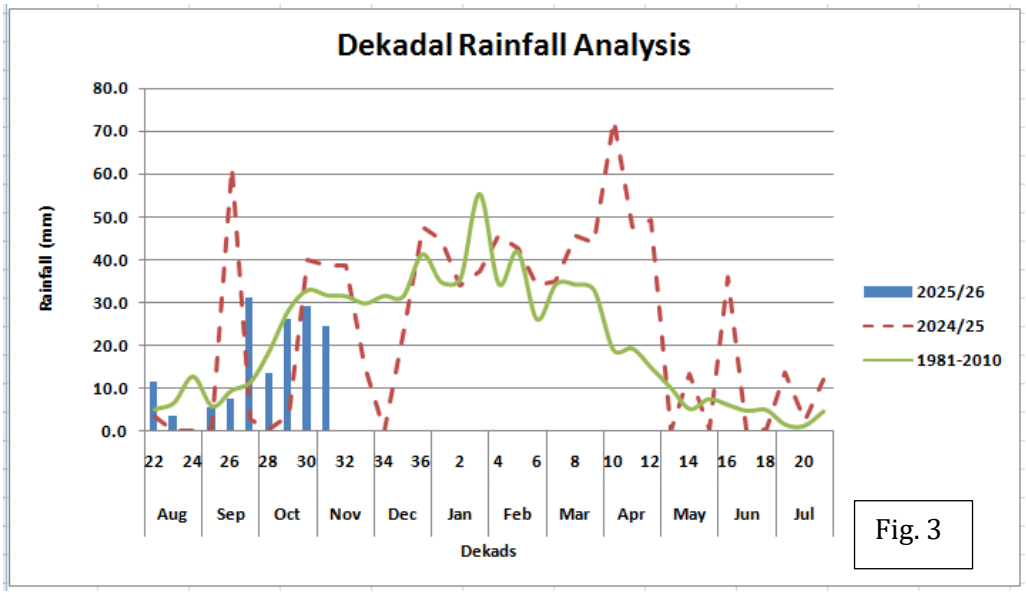


Fig. 3

TEMPERATURE

Observed maximum temperatures for the first dekad of November (Fig.5) were a bit above the long-term normal (Fig.6) for the most part of the country. Cooler temperatures in the high elevated areas remain average shown in both the observed and long-term temperatures.

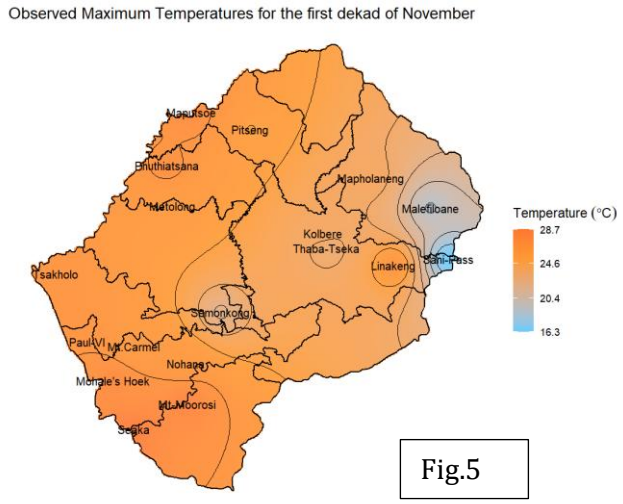


Fig.5

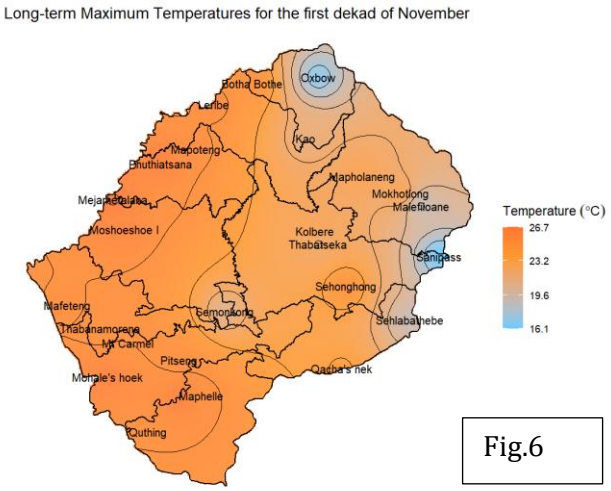
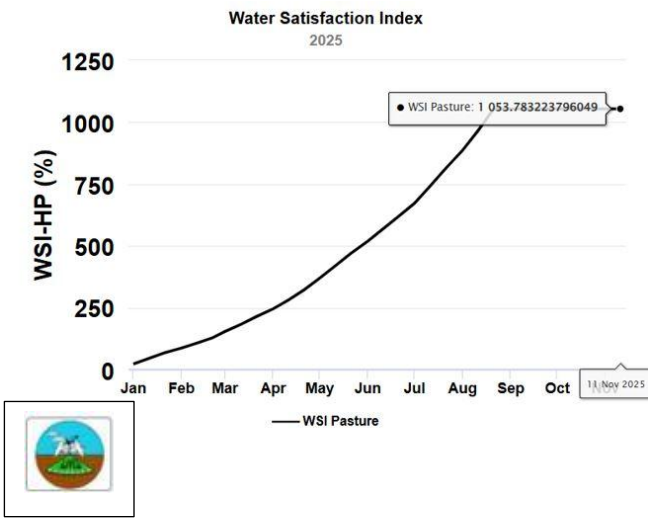


Fig.6

Agricultural Drought Index

Water Satisfaction Index (WSI) for pastures tracks overall availability of water for plant throughout the seasons, Fig.7 shows a positive trend for the year 2025 up to 11th November. The cumulative WSI has reached a high of 1053.78%, this condition is highly favorable for livestock grazing and suggests a good foundation for crop growth in areas where planting is underway or planned.



Weather outlook (13th to 20th NOVEMBER 2025).

WARNING: Heavy rains and thundershowers are anticipated over the country on Saturday 15th, leading to localized flash floods at some places.

Rest of the period.

From the 11th to 14th is expected to be dryer with light and isolated showers, otherwise there is a possibility of heavy rains and thunderstorms, with a potential to localized flooding at some places on Saturday,15th. Strong winds and hailstorms are also anticipated. After the 15th there is reduced chances of rain and thunderstorms. Temperatures are expected to be warm (highlands) to hot (most lowlands) until Saturday, 15th where they will become cooler and thereafter.

Seasonal Outlook (NDJ 2025/26 and JFM-2026)

For the period, covering the rolling seasons from November-December-January (NDJ), December-January-February (DJF) 2025/26, to January-February-March (JFM) 2026, above-normal rainfall conditions are expected to dominate.

N.B. It is important to note that during the summer season, flash floods, thunderstorms, hailstorms, heat waves, and strong winds are frequent and may result in the loss of lives while also posing possible damage to property and crops.

General Comments (Advisory)

OND Season

This is a critical time for land preparation and sowing in all parts of the country. Given the above predictions, farmers are strongly advised to start planting summer crops like maize, potatoes,

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sorghum, beans and horticultural crops; however areas where flooding is experienced should be avoided, especially for planting crops like beans, potatoes and horticultural crops. Farmers should seek guidance from Extension officers for their specific locations on proper sowing dates as well as good management practices.

Climate Smart Agriculture :

Farmers are advised to plant early maturing varieties, use protected structures especially for horticultural crops as temperatures are expected to be warmer. Irrigation schedules for horticultural crops are recommended to support crop growth and development.

Livestock farmers are advised to keep animals under protected structures for protection against intense heat and other weather extremes.

Heavy rainfall

Heavy rainfall can cause waterlogging in seedbeds, nutrient leaching in prepared fields, and rapid surface runoff leading to soil erosion. Farmers should ensure that drainage systems are clear to prevent field waterlogging.

General Recommendations:

- Regular consultations with Extension officers is highly recommended
- Daily weather monitoring and use of indigenous weather forecasts is recommended for signs of significant rainfall patterns shifts
- Water storage during heavy rainfall can be beneficial for irrigation and drinking for animals.

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